
IFESEC

Ijezie Risk Advisory

AtlasPay

SOC 2 Type 1 Readiness Assessment

Executive Briefing

Prepared for: AtlasPay, Inc. Executive Leadership

Engagement: FinTech Payment Processor — SOC 2 Type 1 Readiness

Framework: AICPA SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria, Revision 2022

Scope: Common Criteria (CC) + Availability (A) + Confidentiality (C). Processing Integrity (PI) and Privacy (P) excluded from this engagement.

Audit window target: Q4 2026 (October-December)

Report date: 2026-06-25

Engagement period: FY 2026 Q2-Q3

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Prepared by: IfeSec | Ijezie Risk Advisory

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Consultant credentials: vCISO / Risk Advisory | SOC 2, ISO 27001, HIPAA, FFIEC

Classification: CONFIDENTIAL | INTERNAL // EXECUTIVE READY

AtlasPay has retained IfeSec to conduct a pre-audit SOC 2 Type 1 readiness assessment covering Common Criteria (CC), Availability (A), and Confidentiality (C). This briefing summarizes the engagement's findings for the executive leadership team.

AtlasPay has a functioning control environment. The engagement validated six risk scenarios, mapped them against the SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria, and identified 14 audit walkthrough findings — zero Critical, four High, seven Medium, three Low.

The most material finding is R-04 (Third-Party SaaS Breach), which we recommend be formally accepted at residual High by the Risk Committee. Supply-chain compromise is endemic in FinTech, and AtlasPay's TPRM program and contractual protections reduce blast radius but cannot eliminate occurrence probability. Honest residual scoring here is more defensible than claiming reduction that an auditor would challenge.

With completion of the four High-severity remediation items by 2026-09-30, AtlasPay is positioned for an unqualified SOC 2 Type 1 opinion in the Q4 2026 audit window.

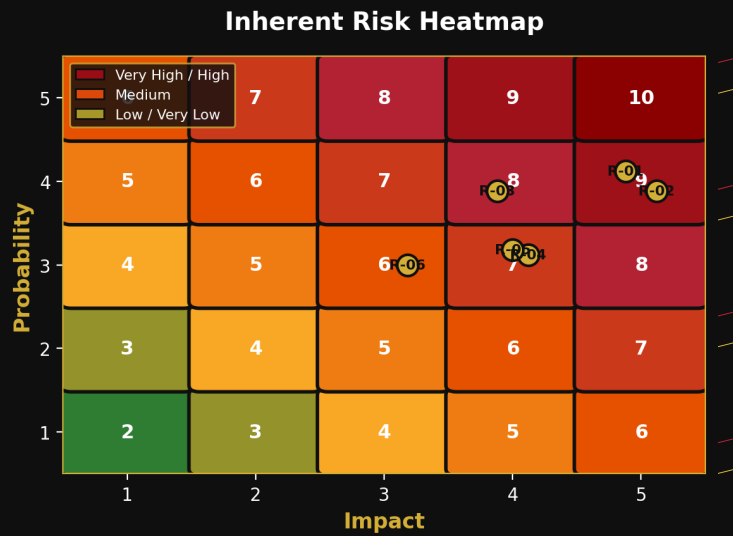


Residual Risk Distribution After Mitigation

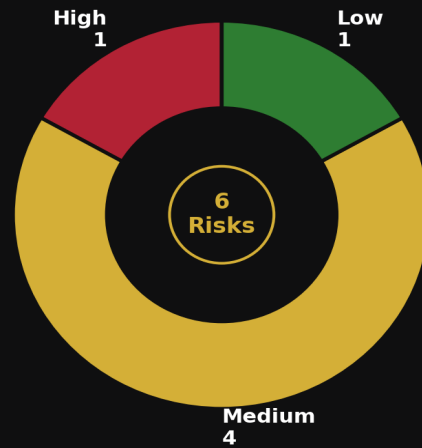
Level	Count	Risks
High	1	R-04 (Vendor Breach) — formally accepted
Medium	4	R-01, R-02, R-03, R-05
Low	1	R-06 (Audit Logging)

Risk Posture

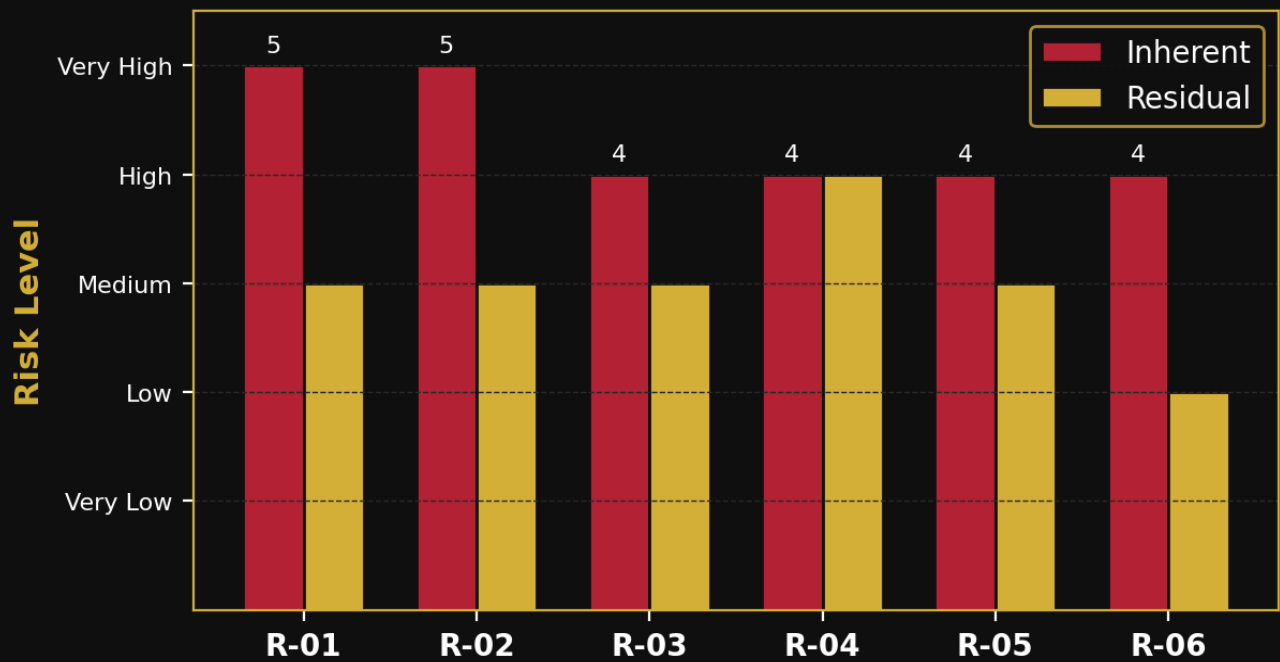
The charts below summarize the engagement risk posture: inherent heatmap, before-and-after risk levels, residual distribution, and the remediation timeline for material findings.



Residual Risk Distribution

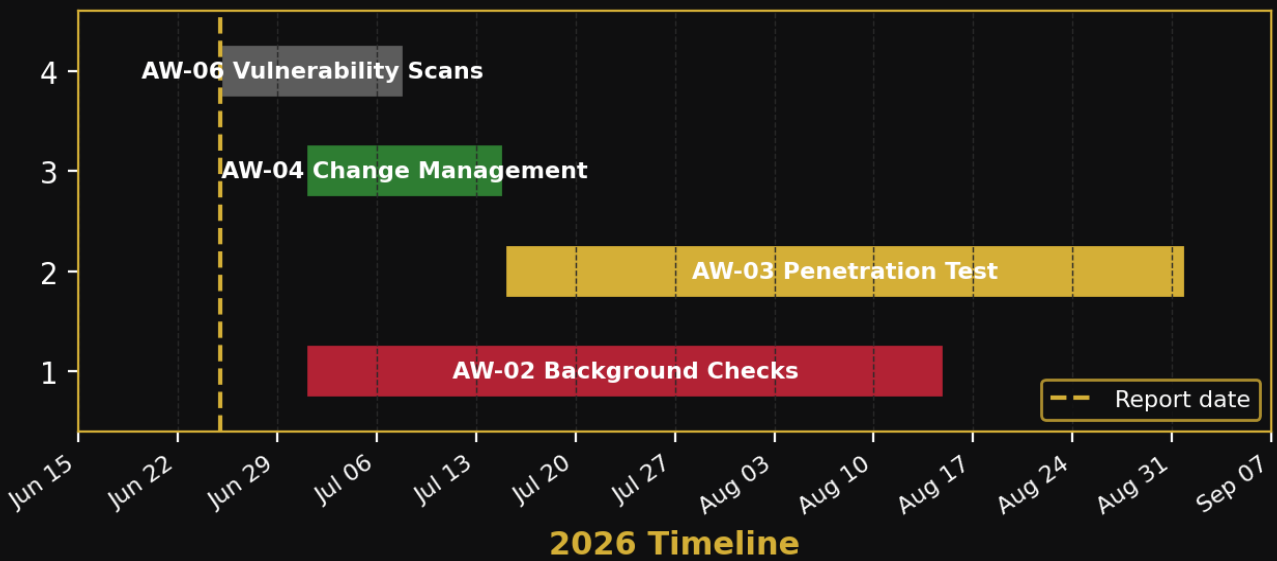


Inherent vs. Residual Risk



The four High-severity findings drive the critical path to the Q4 2026 audit window. Early sequencing reduces audit readiness risk.

High-Severity Remediation Timeline



The engagement followed the standard vCISO pre-audit methodology for SOC 2 Type 1 readiness:

- 1

Scope & Stakeholder Alignment

Define audit scope (CC + A + C), identify stakeholders, confirm audit window target.
- 2

Framework Loading

Load SOC 2 TSC 2022 and supporting mappings (NIST CSF, ISO 27001) into CISO Assistant.
- 3

Risk Register Build

Identify 6 risk scenarios, score on 5x5 ISO-27005 matrix, develop treatment plans.
- 4

Control Mapping

Map 4 policies + 7 vendors + 6 risks against 38 SOC 2 TSC criteria in scope.
- 5

Gap Assessment

Classify each criterion as Covered / Partial / Missing. Document remediation roadmap.
- 6

Audit Walkthrough Simulation

vCISO acts as SOC 2 auditor, walks the platform, surfaces findings, develops management response.

Risk Scoring Reference

All risk scoring uses the 5x5 ISO-27005 matrix (AtlasPay 5x5, URN: urn:atlaspay-5x5, deployed in CISO Assistant v3.18.2). Probability and impact are scored 1-5, the matrix lookup produces the composite level (Very Low, Low, Medium, High, Very High).

P \ I	1 Negligible	2 Minor	3 Moderate	4 Major	5 Catastrophic
5 Almost Certain	6 Medium	7 High	8 High	9 Very High	10 Very High
4 Likely	5 Medium	6 Medium	7 High	8 High	9 Very High
3 Possible	4 Low	5 Medium	6 Medium	7 High	8 High
2 Unlikely	3 Low	4 Low	5 Medium	6 Medium	7 High
1 Rare	2 Very Low	3 Low	4 Low	5 Medium	6 Medium

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Findings Summary

The audit walkthrough surfaced 14 findings across the SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria. Severity ratings reflect the auditor's anticipated response during a Type 1 audit. Management responses and remediation timelines are documented for each.

Severity	Count	Findings
High	4	AW-02, AW-03, AW-04, AW-06
Medium	7	AW-01, AW-05, AW-07, AW-08, AW-10, AW-12, AW-13
Low	3	AW-09, AW-11, AW-14

HIGH

TSC: CC1.4

Issue: Background check policy is drafted but not operational. No vendor selected, no HRIS integration.

Remediation: Select vendor by 2026-08-15. HRIS integration by Q4 2026.

Owner: Head of People + CISO

Target: 2026-08-15

HIGH

TSC: CC2.4, CC7.1

Issue: No external pen test conducted. No retained scan reports.

Remediation: Engage external pen test firm for Q3 2026. Initial report by 2026-09-01.

Owner: CISO

Target: 2026-09-01

HIGH

TSC: CC8.1

Issue: V-04 GPO's workflow exists but not documented as formal control. No CAB minutes.

Remediation: Document Workflow as Change Management Policy within 2 weeks. Establish CAB weekly cadence.

Owner: CTO + CISO

Target: 2026-07-15

Remediation: Document Workflow as Change Management Policy within 2 weeks. Establish CAB weekly cadence.

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HIGH

TSC: CC7.1

Issue: V-05 scanning capability exists but no formal cadence, no retention, no SLA.

Remediation: Configure weekly authenticated scans within 1 week. Remediation SLA: Critical 7d, High 30d, Medium 90d.

Owner: CISO + Engineering

Target: 2026-07-08

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Medium and Low Findings

The following findings are not material individually but should be closed prior to the audit window to strengthen auditor confidence.

ID	Title	Severity	TSC	Target
AW-01	Vendor Tier Classification Not Formalized	Medium	CC9.2	2026-07-23
AW-05	Recovery Test Reports Missing	Medium	A1.3	2026-09-30
AW-07	Policy Attestation Records Missing	Medium	CC1.1, CC1.5	2026-10-31
AW-08	Board Reporting Documentation Missing	Medium	CC1.2, CC2.1	2026-07-22
AW-10	Tabletop Exercise Reports Missing	Medium	CC7.4, CC7.5	2026-12-15
AW-12	Disaster Recovery Plan Document Missing	Medium	A1.3, CC7.5	2026-08-15
AW-13	Risk Acceptance Documentation Missing	Medium	CC3.4	2026-07-22
AW-09	Org Chart Outdated	Low	CC1.3	2026-07-08
AW-11	Records Retention Policy Missing	Low	CC3.5, C1.1	2026-07-15
AW-14	Offboarding Ticket Retention Unclear	Low	CC6.3	2026-08-22

The following recommendations are derived from the audit walkthrough findings and the residual risk acceptance narrative. They are sequenced by urgency and dependency.

RECOMMENDATION R-01

Addresses: AW-02, AW-03, AW-04, AW-06

Target completion 2026-09-30 for all four. Engage external pen test firm (AW-03) first as it has the longest lead time. Document Change Management Policy (AW-04) second as it requires CTO sign-off. Operationalize background checks (AW-02) and vulnerability scan reports (AW-06) in parallel as both require vendor + engineering coordination.

RECOMMENDATION R-02

Addresses: R-04 risk register

Document the Risk Committee acceptance decision with explicit conditions: quarterly vendor risk review, annual SOC 2 Type 2 review for Tier-1 vendors, contractual sub-processor notification rights, cyber insurance coverage. Maintain a re-evaluation trigger if any condition cannot be sustained.

RECOMMENDATION R-03

Addresses: AW-03, CC2.4, CC7.1

Engage a SOC 2-experienced pen test firm. Test scope should cover V-01 (AWS), V-02 (Payment Gateway), V-04 (Application Platform / K8s). Findings remediation tracked through V-05 with Critical = 7 day SLA, High = 30 day SLA.

RECOMMENDATION R-04

Addresses: AW-04, CC6.1

The V-04 GitOps workflow is the de facto control; documentation formalizes it. Establish weekly CAB meeting for production changes. Retain deployment logs for 12 months minimum.

RECOMMENDATION R-05

Addresses: AW-02, CC1.4

Select vendor (Checkr, Sterling, or equivalent). Sign MSA. Integrate with HRIS. Define background check scope: identity, criminal, credit (for finance roles), employment history. Update onboarding checklist to enforce completion.

RECOMMENDATION R-06

Addresses: AW-06, CC7.1

Establish remediation SLA framework. Subscribe to CVE feeds for V-01, V-02, V-04 dependencies. Weekly vulnerability review meeting with CISO + Engineering Lead.

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RECOMMENDATION R-07

Addresses: AW-01, AW-05, AW-07, AW-08, AW-10, AW-12, AW-13

Most impactful Medium findings for audit readiness: AW-08 (board reporting) and AW-12 (risk acceptance documentation) are quick wins. AW-10 (tabletop) and AW-12 (DR plan) require more investment but improve auditor confidence.

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The full risk register is documented in the CISO Assistant platform (folder: AtlasPay, risk assessment RA-ATLSPAY-SOC2). The table below shows the engagement-finalized residual scoring.

ID	Risk	Inherent	Current	Residual	Treatment	Owner
R-01	Privileged Account Compromise	Very High	Medium	Medium	Mitigate	CISO
R-02	Payment Data Exfiltration via API	Very High	Medium	Medium	Mitigate	CISO + CTO
R-03	Ransomware on Production Database Host	High	Medium	Medium	Mitigate	CTO + CISO
R-04	Third-Party SaaS Breach (Vendor Compromise)	High	High	High	Accept (with mitigation)	CTO + Vendor Management
R-05	Insider Threat (Malicious Employee)	High	High	Medium	Mitigate	Head of People + CISO
R-06	Insufficient Audit Logging	High	Low	Low	Mitigate	CISO + Engineering
Very High		High	Medium		Low	Very Low

The Risk Committee has formally accepted residual High for R-04 (Third-Party SaaS Breach) with the following conditions: (1) quarterly vendor risk review with documented minutes; (2) annual SOC 2 Type 2 review for all Tier-1 vendors; (3) contractual sub-processor notification rights enforced; (4) annual tabletop exercise simulating vendor breach; (5) cyber insurance policy maintained with vendor breach coverage.

If any of these conditions cannot be maintained, R-04 should be re-evaluated for treatment change (likely transfer via cyber insurance or escalate to board for risk avoidance discussion).

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The following artifacts are produced by this engagement and stored in the AtlasPay sandbox repository for ongoing reference.

Artifact	Location	Description
Risk Register (full)	lab/docs/soc2-risk-register.md	6 risk scenarios with inherent/current/residual scoring and treatment plans
SOC 2 Control Mapping	lab/docs/soc2-control-mapping.md	38 SOC 2 TSC criteria mapped to policies, risks, and vendors
Gap Assessment	lab/docs/soc2-gap-assessment.md	13 remediation items with severity, owner, target date
Audit Walkthrough	lab/docs/soc2-audit-walkthrough.md	10 walkthrough questions + 14 findings + management response
CISO Assistant Folder	live state, AtlasPay folder	Risk scenarios, policies, vendors, risk assessment
Risk Assessment Container	RA-ATLASPAY-SOC2	Risk Assessment in CISO Assistant holding the 6 risk scenarios

This briefing is produced as part of an IfeSec SOC 2 Type 1 readiness engagement. The findings, recommendations, and remediation roadmap reflect consultant judgment based on artifacts in the AtlasPay sandbox and the engagement's risk register finalization.

Lab-synthetic disclaimer: The risk register values, control mapping status, and audit walkthrough findings reflect a portfolio demonstration engagement. In a real SOC 2 Type 1 readiness engagement, these would be derived from AtlasPay's actual operational state, validated through interviews, observation, and inspection.

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Independent vCISO and Risk Advisory practice. SOC 2 readiness, ISO 27001, HIPAA, FFIEC.

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